revenge for the incident that had been forced upon them by the letter of deceit.

Silence prevailed and no Samarkandi could afford to show any resistance. The slaves (men and women) were taken by Babur. Although Babur still did not seem very sure of taking hold of the town as the complete siege had yet not been established.

The sun appeared to have taken a day off and the chilly wind chapped the noses of the Tīmūrid army. Babur summoned the begs and admitted to the council that they must take refuge in Samarkand as soon as possible as he feared that the cold would affect their progress.

They marched in the vicinity of the fort Khwaja Didar which seemed a safe and appropriate place for a winter quarter. They dismounted in the meadow lying before the fort and put a camp right there. While the camp in the meadows acted as shelter, they indulged in creating huts for a comfortable stay. They stayed in the camp till the winter houses were constructed. For the safer side, few men had ridden to Khwaja Rabadi, Kabud and Shiraj.

On the other hand, Baysonqor Mīrzā had already sent out the message to Shaybāni Khān for help in resisting Babur.

Finally, after exercise of few days, the winter houses were ready. On the very morning when they were erected and secured, Shaybāni Khān stood up front with his men, strong and brave, looking at Babur’s camp. He had ridden from Turkistan at the call of Baysonqor Mīrzā. His appearance had sent shivers down the spines of Babur’s men. They were in no mood to take up any brawl, battle, or fight. But soon they gathered all the motivation they could and stood in a formation deciding to resist Shaybāni strongly. And something unprecedented occurred. Shaybāni Khān showed no sign of any engagement and drove briskly towards Samarkand reaching right up to the main fort. He was not expecting any formidable resistance from Babur’s men as informed by Baysonqor Mīrzā. This had left Baysonqor Mīrzā devastated, and he gave no good reception to Shaybāni. The latter left for Turkistan without causing any trouble or turbulence.

Months passed. Baysonqor Mīrzā sustained this siege-like situation quite well, but now he wanted to do something—though Shaybāni Khān had been of no use. With his remaining ten to fifteen scores of men, he rode to Khusrau Shah in Kunduz as the last retort.